Tricky subjects

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Circle the correct verb. Watch out: a phrase between the subject and the verb does not change the subject, "and" makes a subject plural, and words like everyone, each and nobody are singular.

THREE RULES

1. Subjects joined by AND are plural: Tom and Ana PLAY.
2. With OR, the verb matches the nearer subject: Tom or his sisters PLAY; the sisters or Tom PLAYS.
3. Everyone, everybody, each, nobody, someone, either and neither are singular: Everyone PLAYS.
4. Ignore the phrase between the subject and the verb: The box (of crayons) IS on the shelf.

1.	Maya and her cousin ___ to the same school.	a) go	b) goes
2.	Everyone in the class ___ a library card.	a) have	b) has
3.	The box of crayons ___ on the top shelf.	a) is	b) are
4.	Either the twins or their dad ___ the dishes tonight.	a) wash	b) washes
5.	Each of the puppies ___ a different name.	a) has	b) have
6.	The players on the winning team ___ medals.	a) receives	b) receive
7.	Nobody ___ where the treasure is hidden.	a) know	b) knows
8.	Peanut butter and jelly ___ my favourite sandwich.	a) is	b) are
9.	The teacher or the students ___ the board every day.	a) clean	b) cleans
10.	A bunch of grapes ___ on the counter.	a) sit	b) sits
11.	Neither of the answers ___ correct.	a) is	b) are
12.	The girl with the red boots ___ next door.	a) live	b) lives

Tricky subjects - Answer key

1. a) go 2. b) has 3. a) is 4. b) washes 5. a) has

6. b) receive 7. b) knows 8. a) is 9. a) clean

10. b) sits 11. a) is 12. b) lives

For non-commercial, education use only